

Here's the full curation for **brownie**, anchored to the passage phrase **"handmade cookies, brownies, and simple birthday cakes."** This one is **less polysemous than cookie**, so I'm keeping it conservative: the worthwhile branches are the **chocolate baked dessert**, **brownie points**, **Brownie as a youth-organization member**, and the established folklore sense **brownie = household spirit**. The full **MCQ-ready master list** is included.

BROWNIE

1. Passage anchor

> "...mainly selling handmade cookies, **brownies**, and simple birthday cakes."

Passage meaning

brownie = a rich chocolate baked dessert, usually cut into squares or rectangles

布朗尼；巧克力布朗尼

Here, the speaker means homemade chocolate baked goods sold as part of the dessert business.

Practice

1. She sells chocolate **brownies** at weekends.
她週末售賣巧克力**布朗尼**。
2. These **brownies** are soft in the middle and slightly crisp on top.
這些**布朗尼**中間柔軟，上面則有一點脆。

Core meaning of BROWNIE

2. brownie — chocolate baked dessert

= rich chocolate baked food, usually dense and cut into square or rectangular pieces

布朗尼；巧克力方糕

Examples

1. I baked a tray of **brownies**.
我烤了一盤**布朗尼**。
2. Would you like a **brownie** with your coffee?
你想配咖啡吃一塊**布朗尼**嗎？

This is the exact passage sense.

3. chocolate brownie

= standard brownie made with chocolate or cocoa

****巧克力布朗尼****

Examples

1. She ordered a warm ****chocolate brownie****.
她點了一塊熱的****巧克力布朗尼****。
2. The café serves ****chocolate brownies**** with ice cream.
這家咖啡店會把****巧克力布朗尼****配雪糕一起上。

Texture / baking descriptions

4. fudgy brownie

= dense, moist brownie with a soft, rich texture

****濕潤濃厚型布朗尼；口感似軟朱古力的布朗尼****

Examples

1. I prefer ****fudgy brownies**** to cake-like ones.
比起蛋糕口感的布朗尼，我更喜歡****濕潤濃厚型布朗尼****。
2. These ****brownies**** are especially fudgy.
這些****布朗尼****口感特別濃厚濕潤。

5. cakey brownie

= lighter brownie with a texture more similar to cake

****蛋糕口感的布朗尼****

Examples

1. Some people prefer ****cakey brownies****.
有些人比較喜歡****蛋糕口感的布朗尼****。
2. This recipe produces a lighter, more ****cakey brownie****.
這個食譜做出的布朗尼較鬆軟，****比較像蛋糕****。

These are baking descriptions rather than distinct lexical senses.

Idiom: brownie points

6. brownie points

Informal:

= imaginary credit you gain by pleasing, helping, or impressing someone

印象分；討好所得的加分；好感分

Examples

1. He earned some **brownie points** by helping with the cleanup.

他主動幫忙清理，因此賺到了一些**好感分**。

2. Buying flowers might get you a few **brownie points**.

買花也許可以幫你賺到一些**印象分**。

This is the most important figurative use.

7. earn / get brownie points

= gain approval or favor from someone

加分；贏得好感

Examples

1. She got **brownie points** for remembering everyone's birthday.

她因記得每個人的生日而**大大加分**。

2. He was clearly trying to earn **brownie points** with the manager.

他顯然是在努力向經理**討好加分**。

Brownie — youth organization

8. Brownie

Capitalized:

= young member of the Brownies, a section of Guiding/Scouting organizations for girls in several countries

****女童軍幼年組成員；Brownie 女童軍****

Examples

1. She joined the ****Brownies**** when she was young.
她小時候加入了 ****Brownies 女童軍****。

2. The ****Brownies**** met every Thursday.
****Brownies 女童軍幼年組****每星期四聚會。

Capitalization matters.

9. the Brownies

= organization or section for younger girls within the Guiding movement

****女童軍幼年組****

Examples

1. Her daughter belongs to the ****Brownies****.
她的女兒參加了****女童軍幼年組****。

2. The ****Brownies**** organized a community activity.
****女童軍幼年組****舉辦了一項社區活動。

Folklore

10. brownie — household spirit

In Scottish and northern English folklore:

= small supernatural household spirit traditionally believed to help with chores at night

****家宅精靈；棕仙****

Examples

1. In old stories, a ****brownie**** might secretly help with housework.
在古老故事中，****家宅精靈****可能會偷偷幫忙做家務。

2. The tale features a helpful **brownie** living near the farm.

故事中有一個住在農場附近、樂於幫忙的**小精靈**。

This is established culturally, but lower priority than the food and idiom senses.

Useful compounds

11. brownie mix

= prepared dry mixture used to make brownies

布朗尼預拌粉

Examples

1. Add eggs and butter to the **brownie mix**.

在**布朗尼預拌粉**中加入雞蛋和牛油。

2. She used a boxed **brownie mix**.

她使用盒裝**布朗尼預拌粉**。

Transparent culinary compound.

12. brownie batter

= uncooked mixture from which brownies are baked

布朗尼麵糊

Examples

1. Pour the **brownie batter** into the pan.

把**布朗尼麵糊**倒進烤盤。

2. The **batter** should be thick and smooth.

布朗尼麵糊應該濃稠而均勻。

Lower-priority proper-name sense

13. Brownie camera

Historical:

= inexpensive Kodak camera line that became extremely well known in the twentieth century
Brownie 相機

Examples

1. Old photographs were sometimes taken with a **Brownie camera**.
一些舊照片曾使用 **Brownie 相機** 拍攝。
2. The **Brownie** helped popularize casual photography.
Brownie 相機 曾推動日常攝影普及。

This is a historical proper-name use rather than a general modern lexical sense, so it is low priority for MCQs.

Key contrasts

14. brownie vs cake

brownie

= usually denser, richer, flatter, and cut into pieces
布朗尼

cake

= generally lighter and more risen in texture
蛋糕

Compare:

> chocolate cake
> 巧克力蛋糕

> chocolate brownie
> 巧克力布朗尼

15. brownie vs cookie

cookie

= individual small baked item made from dough
曲奇

brownie

= usually baked as one tray and then cut into dense chocolate squares

****布朗尼****

The passage lists them as separate dessert products.

16. brownie vs blondie

****brownie****

= traditionally chocolate/cocoa based

****巧克力布朗尼****

****blondie****

= similar dense baked bar usually based on brown sugar/vanilla rather than cocoa

****金黃布朗尼；非朱古力型方糕****

Examples

1. She sells both ****brownies and blondies****.

她同時售賣****布朗尼和 blondie 方糕****。

2. A ****blondie**** usually does not have cocoa as its main flavor.

****Blondie**** 通常不以可可作主要味道。

Meaning map

The word ****brownie**** has one dominant everyday sense:

Food

brownie

→ ****布朗尼****

From outside the food sense come several established lexical branches:

Approval

brownie points

→ ****印象分 / 好感分****

Youth organization

Brownie

→ **女童軍幼年組成員**

Folklore

brownie

→ **家宅精靈**

A historical proper-name branch is:

Photography

Brownie camera

→ **Brownie 相機**

Unlike a highly polysemous word such as **set** or **plot**, **brownie** should not be artificially split further.

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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brownie — dessert	以巧克力 / 可可製成、通常切成方塊的濃厚烘焙甜點；布朗尼
chocolate brownie	巧克力布朗尼
fudgy brownie	口感濕潤、濃厚、密實的布朗尼
cakey brownie	口感較鬆軟、較像蛋糕的布朗尼
brownie points	因討好、幫忙或表現良好而獲得的非正式「好感分 / 印象分」
earn/get brownie points	因某種行為而贏得某人的好感 / 加分
Brownie — member	女童軍較年幼組別的成員
the Brownies	女童軍中的幼年組
brownie — folklore	蘇格蘭等民間傳說中會暗中幫忙做家務的家宅精靈
brownie mix	製作布朗尼用的預拌粉
brownie batter	尚未烘焙的布朗尼麵糊
Brownie camera	歷史上的 Kodak Brownie 系列相機

Passage recap

> “...mainly selling handmade cookies, **brownies**, and simple birthday cakes.”

Here:

brownie = **a dense chocolate baked dessert usually cut into squares**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **布朗尼**

* **巧克力布朗尼**

Natural contextual translation:

主要售賣手工曲奇、布朗尼，以及一些簡單的生日蛋糕。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

brownie

= **a rich chocolate baked dessert, usually baked in a tray and cut into squares or rectangles**

布朗尼；巧克力方糕

The most important non-food distinction is:

> **eat a brownie**

> → 吃一塊布朗尼

but:

> **earn brownie points**

> → **賺取好感分 / 在某人心中加分**

And with capitalization:

> **a Brownie**

> → 女童軍幼年組成員

So **brownie** is useful for the database, but it has a **smaller, cleaner meaning inventory** than words such as **cookie**, **plot**, or **base**.